

E-Commerce Sales Analysis (SQL)

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What This Project Is About

I wanted to work through a realistic retail scenario using SQL, so I built a small e-commerce database from scratch with three related tables covering customers, products, and orders, and ran a full analysis on top of it.

The business question I was trying to answer was: who are our best customers, which products are actually making us money, and is revenue growing over time? These are the kinds of questions I'd expect to get from a sales or operations team, so I tried to write queries that answer them directly rather than just showing off syntax.

Tools

- **PostgreSQL** (version 15)
- **pgAdmin 4**

Dataset

Three CSV files are in the `/data` folder. Import them into PostgreSQL in this order to avoid foreign key errors:

1. `customers.csv` - 15 customers with their city and join date
2. `products.csv` - 10 products across Electronics, Footwear, and Fitness categories
3. `orders.csv` - 40 orders placed between 2022 and 2023

How To Set Up The Database

1. Open pgAdmin and connect to your PostgreSQL server
2. Create a new database called `ecommerce_db`
3. Open the Query Tool and run `ecommerce_analysis.sql` from top to bottom, this creates all three tables

4. Right-click each table, click Import/Export Data, select the matching CSV, toggle Header ON and click OK
5. Import order: `customers.csv` first, then `products.csv` , then `orders.csv`

Queries Covered

Step	What It Does
1	Create the three tables with proper data types and foreign keys
2	Explore the data, row counts and previews
3	Total revenue per product using a JOIN
4	Top 5 customers by total spend
5	Monthly revenue trend using date formatting
6	Revenue share by category using a CTE
7	Customer rankings using the RANK() window function
8	Customer segmentation with CASE WHEN (High / Mid / Low Value)

Key Findings

- **Electronics drove the most revenue overall**, mainly because of the Smart Watch and Wireless Headphones. Higher price points matter more than units sold when it comes to total revenue.
- **London customers made up the highest proportion of top spenders**, which lines up with the fact that more customers are based there than anywhere else.
- **Revenue grew steadily across 2023** with a noticeable pickup in Q4, consistent with typical seasonal shopping patterns.
- The CASE WHEN segmentation showed only 3 customers qualified as High Value, which is a useful flag for any loyalty programme the business might want to run.

Skills Demonstrated

- Table design with foreign key relationships

- Multi-table JOINS
- Aggregate functions (SUM, COUNT)
- Date formatting with TO_CHAR
- CTEs (WITH clause)
- Window functions using RANK() and SUM() OVER()
- CASE WHEN for customer segmentation